

Farm Fresh Egg Handling

FROM THE NEST BOX TO THE KITCHEN.

To Wash or Not to Wash

Freshly laid eggs have a natural protective coating called the **bloom** — an invisible seal that keeps bacteria out and moisture in. An unwashed egg with its bloom intact stays fresh on the counter for weeks. Once you wash it, the bloom is gone and the egg needs refrigeration.

If your eggs are clean — no visible dirt or droppings — don't wash them. You're removing a free preservation system. Brush off loose debris with a dry cloth and store.

If an egg is dirty, wash it under **warm running water** (warmer than the egg — never cold). Cold water makes the contents contract, pulling bacteria through the shell. Rub gently with your fingers, no soap. Dry immediately. Refrigerate washed eggs right away.

DO

- Warm water — warmer than the egg
- Rinse under running water
- Dry immediately
- Refrigerate after washing

DON'T

- Cold water — pulls bacteria in
- Soak eggs in standing water
- Use soap or detergent
- Wash clean eggs

How to Store

Unwashed eggs: Store pointy-end-down on the counter. Use within 2–3 weeks. Keep out of direct sunlight. Once refrigerated, don't move back to the counter — condensation invites bacteria.

Washed eggs: Store pointy-end-down in the fridge, in the carton. The air cell is at the blunt end — storing pointy-end-down keeps the yolk centered and slows aging. Don't store in the door.

Is It Still Good? — The Float Test

Fill a bowl with cool water. Place the egg in gently.

- **Sinks and lies flat** — very fresh. Good for anything.
- **Sinks but stands upright** — still fine, just older. Use soon. Best for baking or hard-boiling.
- **Floats** — past its prime. Crack into a separate bowl. If it smells fine, use it. If it smells off at all, compost.

The float test tells you age, not safety. A floating egg isn't automatically bad — it's just old. Trust your nose. A bad egg is unmistakable.

Quick Tips

- **Date your eggs.** Pencil the collection date on the shell. Newest in back, oldest in front.
- **Crack into a separate bowl.** One bad egg ruins the batch. Crack each egg into a small dish first.
- **Collect often.** Twice a day in hot weather. Clean nest boxes mean clean eggs — less washing, more blooms intact.